

Troubleshooting Joysticks

Make sure your joystick is connected properly

Some joystick connectors fit loosely into the interface and will become dislodged if the cable is pulled even a little. Check the connection first to make sure your problems are not being caused by a dislodged connector. First, shut down your computer. Make sure the joystick connector is firmly connected to the correct port. When you have finished checking the connector, reboot your machine.

Enable joystick control in your game

Games will often assume that you want to use a joystick. If you want joystick control in your games, make sure it's enabled. Many games will give you an option to select joystick, keyboard or mouse. Check your game's documentation to see how to enable joystick control.

Be sure only one joystick port is active on your system

No more than one joystick port can be active on your system at one time. If you happen to have more than one port active, your joystick will not function properly. You may encounter this situation if you have recently purchased a dedicated game card, recently upgraded your sound card, or if your joystick is plugged into a dedicated I/O controller.

Check to see that you have the correct driver installed

Sometimes problems can arise if the wrong joystick driver is loaded. Check the driver in Windows Control Panel to make sure the correct one is installed.

Calibrate in Windows Control Panel

Open **Game Controllers** in the Control Panel. Under **Installed game controllers**, click the controller you want to calibrate, and then click **Properties**. Here, on the **Settings** tab, click **Calibrate**, and then follow the instructions on your screen.

Testing a game controller

Again, open **Game Controllers** in Control Panel, and under **Installed game controllers**, click the controller you want to test, and then click **Properties**. On the **Test** tab, test your controller by moving or pressing each control, including the stick, wheel, yoke, pads and buttons. After performing each of these actions with the controller, view the results on the **Test** tab.

Other Possibilities

Make sure the proper game port driver for your sound card or graphics card is installed

Check your sound card and graphics card documentation to make sure you have the correct driver installed. Having the wrong driver will result in your joystick not working properly. You can usually find the game port driver under 'sound, video and game controllers' in the Device Manager.

Power management

Joystick calibration relies on timing. If the CPU speed of a system changes, so does the joystick calibration. Sometimes power management will activate and change the CPU speed to conserve power. This may cause the joystick to behave erratically. You may want to try disabling power management temporarily to see if this is causing the problem.

Older sound cards, I/O cards, speed-fixed game cards

If you have an older game card, sound card or I/O card, you may want to upgrade to a dedicated, speed-adjustable game controller. The joystick ports on older game controllers can't handle the speed and timing requirements of newer games. Such joystick ports, which were designed for a slower system, may cause problems on faster PCs.

Recently upgraded to a faster CPU

If you upgraded your CPU, you may have some timing issues. You may want to check your motherboard manual and make sure the system settings in CMOS are recommended for your CPU by the motherboard manufacturer.

Resolving USB controller installation issues

In Device Manager, USB game controllers are listed under Human Interface devices (in the 'Devices by type' view). If the controller does not appear in Device Manager, USB may not be enabled in the BIOS. When you are prompted as you start your computer, enter BIOS setup, and enable USB. However, if USB is enabled in BIOS but the USB host controller does not appear in Device Manager (under Universal Serial Bus controllers), or a yellow warning icon appears next to the host controller name, you may need to get current drivers for the motherboard. Contact your computer vendor and obtain the latest version. If the controller does appear in Device Manager, right-click the controller name and then Properties. Problems and suggested actions are displayed under Device Status.

